and Lieutenant General Bogey Sen. As I have pointed out earlier, with General Thimayya went Lieutenant Generals Thorat and S.D. Verma. Even Major General Sam Manekshaw was not spared. After the fall of Tawang on 23 October, the new crop of officers who took over 4 Division and the various brigades in the Kameng Sector were all personally selected by General Pran Thapar. They failed to show even the slightest semblance of a fight when, three weeks later, the Chinese push became a shove.

In 1953, General Kulwant Singh's report not only looked at the entire India-China border from a military point of view, it warned that the Chinese would go in for limited military action any time after 1961. Throughout this period while Nehru privately expressed his misgivings about the Chinese, in public he was adamant that there was no threat from them. In the east, had it not been for Jairam Das Daulatram, the Governor of Assam between 1949 and 1956, NEFA might have been lost to the Chinese, like Aksai Chin. It is a well-known fact that when Major Ralengnao Bob Khathing came to meet Nehru in New Delhi after his expedition to Tawang, Nehru was furious with him and wanted to know who had authorized the expedition.

The Panchsheel Agreement, signed between India and China, reflected Nehru's idealism that was far removed from the world of realpolitik. At that stage, India at least held some cards, the most important perhaps being the physical access to Lhasa. Nehru chose to discard them without getting in return any concessions from the Chinese in Tibet. Not only that, the Government of India then began to hide from its own people Chinese transgressions on the border. There too the Chinese played it perfectly– engineering trouble in the Middle Sector in the vicinity of the Niti Pass while staying well clear of the Northern and Eastern sectors. After having established that the border was indeed disputed, who ever heard of Barahoti (or Wu-Je as the Chinese called it) again?

Before I end this study of 1962, a quick summary of the whole affair would be in order In 1957, the arrival of General Thimayya at the helm of the Indian Army was hailed as a new beginning. Timmy was quite popular with Nehru (or he would never have been made chief) but to clip his wings the prime minister appointed the firebrand Krishna Menon as the defence minister. A lot of post-war venom has been directed at Menon for his role and style of functioning, but Menon was simply doing what Nehru wanted him to do, as was the case with Kaul. Nehru's interest in Kaul's career and his subsequent rise to the top had begun as far back as 1947; from being